



▼ Passage to Australia

Passengers pose aboard the SS *Sobrarón*, which plied the England-Australia route from 1866-1891. The vessel catered to first- and second-class passengers only.

colonizers. Some were murdered in cold blood by settlers, and others were kidnapped by seal hunters and forced to become unpaid domestic workers.

Indigenous Australian women have a history of activism and they continue to be recognized in many areas of public life. Poet Oodgeroo Noonuccal campaigned successfully for the 1967 abolition of discriminatory, anti-Aboriginal sections of the Australian constitution. Tracey Moffatt is regarded as one of Australia's top artists; her work often focuses on how Aboriginal people are understood culturally.

Māori women sign treaty

Before the Europeans arrived, Māori status was determined by descent from ancestors, not by gender, and women often

had important roles. Māori women, for example, were signatories to New Zealand's founding document, the Treaty of Waitangi. However, the Europeans, believing that the differentiation between civilization and savagery was partly determined by how a society treated and protected its women, imposed their perception of gender roles on the Māori people. After colonization, Māori women lost their equal status, a grievance that continues to motivate Māori women's activism today.

Prominent female Māori activists include women's suffrage campaigner Meri Te Tai Mangakahia. In 1893, she not only requested that Māori women be given the vote, but that they be eligible to sit in the Māori parliament, thus going a step further than her contemporaries in the European suffrage

